

Mold.log — Controlled Experiment

Darius Nazarov, 2026 · interactive digital installation + three prints



Description

A Petri dish is the purest bubble there is: a sealed, transparent world where something is allowed to grow only because it cannot get out. Mold.log puts the visitor in charge of that bubble. On a screen, they place spores into a virtual dish, choose a strain (named after real fungi and bacteria), and watch the colonies branch, layer and collide — each competing for the same closed space, each adding its own voice to a slowly building soundscape. The image is monochrome and pixelated, like a laboratory record. The visitor can pause the growth, burn the dish clean and start again, or export the moment as a PNG.

The work came out of my own unease with mold — the invisible world that quietly eats the spaces we live in. I can only look at it inside a bubble: mediated, contained, reversible. That protection is also the limit — nothing in the dish ever meets the world outside. Visitors in the exhibition can decide what to do with that: keep growing, or burn it and see what returns.

Installation

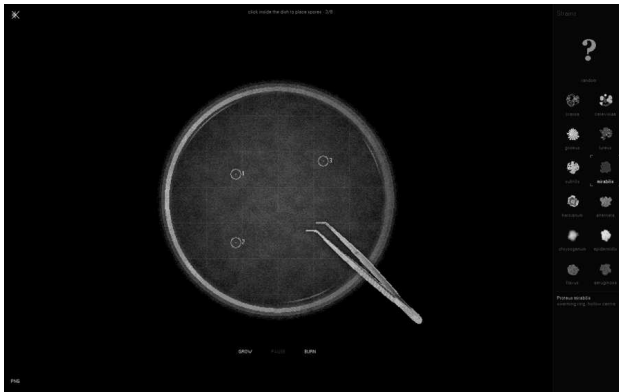
1. Station. One screen (monitor or TV, 24–43"), one mouse, one small speaker at low volume, on a small table or shelf, or a screen on the wall with a mouse on a ledge below. No keyboard. The work runs in a browser from a single link and can be installed in ten minutes by the Neue Bäckerei team; I provide a kiosk build that starts automatically and runs offline. Hardware: if the space has a spare screen/computer, no shipping is needed; otherwise I can ship a mini-PC (≈1 kg) within the €100 shipping support, or the €300 fee can cover a used monitor locally — to be agreed.

2. Records. Three prints from exported dishes, monochrome, A3 (29.7 × 42 cm) on matte paper, unframed or in simple black frames, hung in a row beside the screen. Shipped from Belgrade in a flat tube.

Dimensions: station ≈ 60 × 50 × 45 cm (table) or wall-mounted; prints 3 × A3. **Space needed:** ≈ 1.5 m of wall or a corner. **Power:** one socket. **Internet:** only for first load. **Sound:** optional, low.

Availability: the work is finished and available for the full period 1 December 2026 – 9 January 2027.

Documentation, images and the playable version: <https://daryxyz.github.io/petri-mold/> · https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1zaVo7N3MKv_c3ov3awPn4IomXxDs-FVz



Left: the station view (strain panel, dish). Right: BURN — the bubble cleared.

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